DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 4

Data visualisation specialist

Profession 4 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A visualisation specialist designs charts and dashboards that show patterns accurately and quickly.

What professionals do every day

Chooses chart types for the question, designs layouts, checks colour contrast, removes clutter and tests readability with the audience.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

A good chart makes the answer obvious. A bad one misleads or hides the point.

- Charts that mislead through scale or colour.
- Dashboards with too many numbers.
- Colours that fail for colour-blind readers.

Skills you need

- Chart types and when to use them.
- Colour and contrast (see the Design textbook).
- Dashboard layout.
- Accuracy: honest axes and labels.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Power BI Desktop	Dashboards	Free	Power BI Pro and Premium plans (verify)	powerbi.microsoft.com/desktop/
Tableau Public	Charts (free public version)	Free	Paid desktop	public.tableau.com
Google Looker Studio	Dashboards	Free	Free	lookerstudio.google.com
ColorBrewer	Colour palettes for maps and charts	Free	Free	colorbrewer2.org

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	Redraw one misleading chart honestly.
Intermediate	Pick the chart type for five questions.

Advanced	Design a one-page dashboard.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Dashboard for a training firm.
- **Intermediate:** Market share chart set.
- **Advanced:** Executive summary visuals.

Client-ready portfolio project

A one-page dashboard for a fictional shop with five charts, each answering one question, and a note on each design choice.

Worked example

Worked example. A bar chart with an axis starting at 90 exaggerates a 3% difference; starting the axis at zero shows it honestly.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Honest chart redraw

Business problem: A chart shows growth with a truncated axis.

Steps

1. Identify the misleading choice.
2. Redraw with an axis from zero and direct labels.
3. Check the colours for contrast.
4. Write one sentence on what the chart now shows.

Expected output: The before and after chart and the sentence.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

Starting at zero shows the true size of the change. Direct labels remove the need for a legend. The contrast check keeps labels readable.

Common mistakes

- Truncated axes.
- Pie charts with many slices.
- Rainbow palettes.
- Too many charts on one page.

Freelancing opportunities

- Dashboard design for analytics clients.

- Chart cleanup for reports.
- Briefs for 'data visualisation', 'dashboard design', 'Power BI report design'.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Data-to-Viz (chart choice guide)

Part of **Master Freelancing: Data Analytics and Data Science**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.